



THE UNIVERSITY OF
MELBOURNE

CURRENT STUDENTS IA · PROSPECTIVE EXPERIENCE

The prospective student experience

The applicant journey across [study.unimelb](#) and the estate — discover, compare, apply, enrol. June 2026.

University of Melbourne · June 2026

The University of Melbourne acknowledges the Traditional Owners of the unceded land on which we work, learn and live, and pays respect to their Elders, past and present, and to Indigenous Australians today.

The applicant journey across the University's public web estate — discover → compare → check eligibility & cost → apply → offer → accept → enrol — traced through the path-level link graph. Focus: prospective/future students, the audience `study.unimelb.edu.au` (4,048 pages) is built to convert. June 2026.

Executive summary

The prospective estate is large, content-rich and, in places, genuinely good — tuition is per-course, the persuasion layer is wired to the practical funnel, and `study.unimelb` is unambiguously the canonical owner. But read end-to-end, the applicant journey has one defining flaw: **it never closes the loop on its own site**. At every decisive moment the journey hands off — to the **Handbook** for what a degree actually contains, to a **CRM form** that captures a *lead* rather than starting an application, or to a **walled portal** (VTAC, eStudent eApplications) where the real action happens out of view. The site that exists to *convert* prospective students is structurally unable to take them from "interested" to "applied" without ejecting them into a different platform, a different standard, or a different system.

Three faults compound this. **Comparison — the single most important prospective task — does not exist**: 427 courses are rendered as isolated 7-tab micro-sites with no shortlist or compare, so a student weighing three degrees juggles 21 browser tabs by hand. **The "Apply" action is fragmented across at least three disconnected systems** (VTAC for domestic undergraduates, eStudent for graduate/international, a CRM enquiry form everywhere) with no single "Apply" path and the loudest button collecting an email address. And **the apply→enrol handoff is a single cold cross-domain link** — only domestic VTAC undergraduates get a guided "you got in, here's what's next"; everyone else falls off the prospective site into the current-student estate with no transition.

The prize is conversion and continuity: make the catalogue comparable, make "Apply" one owned path, pull the decision-critical Handbook detail into the course view, and build the offer→enrol bridge the funnel is missing.

The prospective estate at a glance

<code>study.unimelb.edu.au</code> total pages	4,048
Course catalogue (<code>/find/courses</code>)	2,944 (73%)
Distinct courses behind it	~427 (rendered as 7-tab micro-sites)
Application journey (<code>/how-to-apply</code>)	280 (segmented by audience)
Persuasion (<code>/study-with-us</code> + <code>/student-life</code>)	274
Links OUT to the Handbook (course detail)	4,391
Links OUT to the CRM funnel (<code>forms.your</code>)	1,493
Links to scholarships discovery	411
Apply→enrol handoff (<code>study</code> → <code>students.unimelb</code>)	373 (thin)
Faculty-hosted <code>/study/</code> pages (parallel funnel)	817 across 14 faculties
Page weight (median / max)	304 KB / 1.1 MB (heaviest estate)

The recurring patterns across the journey

- 1. The journey never closes the loop on-site.** Every stage funnels OUT — to the Handbook (course/subject detail, 4,391 links), to `forms.your` (1,493 CRM "Register for updates" leads), or to a walled application portal. Discovery, eligibility and apply all terminate in a system the prospect can't evaluate from the catalogue. (*course discovery, how-to-apply, eligibility, international*)
- 2. "Apply" is not one path.** The most decisive action forks silently by audience across VTAC (external government admissions, domestic UG), the eStudent eApplications portal (graduate/international), and the CRM enquiry form — the applicant must self-diagnose which applies. There is no single owned "Apply" path. (*how-to-apply, international*)

3. Comparison — the core prospective task — is absent. 427 courses as isolated 7-tab micro-sites (landing + structure + entry + fees + how-to-apply + outcomes + experience), a keyword-only Funnelback search, no shortlist/compare. Decision-critical attributes are split across seven tabs and two platforms. (*course discovery*)

4. Decision-critical detail lives on a different platform. What a degree actually contains (subjects, electives, prerequisites) is on the Handbook — a different platform, visual standard and academic register — so the prospect is ejected mid-decision. 88% of the 4,483 Handbook deep-links come from just 153 `/structure/` pages. (*course discovery, eligibility*)

5. Cost and eligibility are present but not self-serviceable. Tuition is per-course (good), but the wider affordability story (loans, cost-of-living, scholarships) is scattered and audience-split, and eligibility rarely resolves to a yes/no — the authoritative requirements deep-link the Handbook again. (*fees/cost, eligibility*)

6. Faculty and multi-owner duplication. 817 faculty-hosted `/study/` pages parallel the central catalogue, and faculties push prospective traffic back the other way (medicine→study 604, education→study 545) — multiple owners describing the same courses, with the central catalogue the only place a course is fully described and transacted. (*central-vs-faculty*)

7. A performance tax at the top of funnel. `study.unimelb` is the heaviest estate (median 304 KB, max 1.1 MB) — the decision pages are the slowest to load, on the audience most likely to be on mobile or limited data. (*decision/persuasion*)

Per-stage deep-dives

Course discovery & comparison (prospective) [HIGH]

A 427-course catalogue rendered as ~1,325 template pages and a JS Funnelback search, with no real compare tool and a deep dependency on the Handbook — discovery works as keyword search, but "comparison" is left entirely to the prospective student across two platforms.

What exists. `study.unimelb/find/` = 3,361 pages, dominated by `/find/courses` (2,944) plus study-areas (102), microcredentials (110), short-courses (35), pathways (30). The catalogue is 427 distinct courses (graduate-heavy: 959 graduate page-rows vs 154 UG, 142 majors, 37 honours) each rendered as a 7-tab micro-site — landing + `/structure/` + `/entry-requirements/` + `/fees/` + `/how-to-apply/` + `/career-outcomes/` + `/student-experience/` (counts: 481 landings, 159 structure, 158 career-outcomes, 128 how-to-apply, 125 fees, 123 student-experience, 122 entry-req). The browse entry point `/find/` is a Funnelback faceted search (30 'funnelback' + 37 'facet' refs in 200KB of JS-heavy HTML; `collection=find-a-course / uom~sp-courses`). `study.unimelb` is the heaviest estate (median 304KB, p90 416KB, max 1.1MB per page-weight.csv).

Journey friction

- NO real compare/save tool: course landing and `/fees/` pages expose only 'Enquire' and 'Register for updates' CTAs (`forms.your.unimelb`) — a prospect comparing 3 courses must open 3 separate 7-tab micro-sites in tabs and reconcile by hand. The 125 'compare'/143 'shortlist' HTML hits are FALSE POSITIVES — admissions prose ('shortlisted applicants'), Open Day session shortlists, not a course tool.
- Browse is search-only: `/find/` is a Funnelback keyword box with facets — no genuine taxonomy browse. Faceting/pagination state explodes into 86+ crawlable URL snapshots (`?...start_rank=13/25/.../169, f.Tabs|typeCourse, f.Tabs|typeMaMiSp`) — catalogue sprawl as search-state explosion, with three parallel result collections (`find-a-course` vs `uom~sp-courses`).
- The seam is a platform-switch mid-decision: to see what a degree actually contains (subjects/electives), the prospect must leave `study.unimelb` for `handbook.unimelb` — a different platform with a different visual standard and an academic-reference register, not a marketing one.
- Decision-critical attributes are split across the 7 tabs and across two sites: fees on `/fees/`, ATAR/prereqs on `/entry-requirements/` (which deep-links Handbook), subject list on `/structure/` (~26 Handbook links/page) — no single at-a-glance course card.
- The real application step is invisible/uncrawlable: every course funnels to enquiry forms or a walled application portal; discovery never closes the loop on-site.

Fragmentation

- Central vs Handbook (by design, but jarring): 3,962 of 4,483 handbook deep-links (88%) originate from just 153 /structure/ pages — e.g. Bachelor of Commerce /structure/ links Handbook 116x, B.Biomedicine 108x, B.Design 102x. study.unimelb owns the persuasion layer; handbook.unimelb owns subject/course DETAIL on a separate platform/standard. Landing and /fees/ pages carry ZERO handbook links — the handoff is concentrated, not consistent.
- Central vs faculty duplication: 817 faculty-hosted /study/ pages parallel the central funnel (biomedical 189, education 133, finearts-music 122, law 61, science 36), and faculties inject prospective traffic back the other way (medicine→study 604, education→study 545, arts→study 531) — multiple owners describing the same courses.
- Within study itself: study-areas (102 thematic hubs) funnel to course landings but a course is ALSO reachable via Funnelback search and via faculty /study/ — three discovery paths, no canonical one. Three Funnelback collections (find-a-course, uom~sp-courses, _default) further split results.

The seam. study.unimelb → handbook.unimelb (4,391 contextual links overall; 88% from /structure/ pages). This is the defining handoff of the stage: course-level marketing on study.unimelb, but subject/elective/requirement DETAIL on the Handbook — a different platform, visual standard, and register. A second, thinner seam exits the stage forward: course pages push to forms.your.unimelb (1,493 'Register for updates' enquiry links) and then to a walled application portal that is uncrawlable — so discovery hands off into systems the prospect cannot evaluate from the catalogue.

Recommendation. Treat 'compare' as the missing core capability, not a nice-to-have: add a persistent shortlist/compare across the 427 courses that surfaces fees, ATAR/entry, duration, intake and a subject snapshot on one card — so comparison stops being manual tab-juggling across a 7-tab micro-site x N. Pull the decision-critical Handbook data (course structure/subject list) INTO the study.unimelb course view (or embed it) so the prospect isn't ejected to a different-standard platform mid-decision; reserve the deep Handbook link for full academic reference. Collapse the Funnelback search-state sprawl (canonicalise facet/pagination URLs to one indexable result set; pick one collection) and add a true taxonomy browse alongside keyword search. Rationalise the 817 faculty /study/ pages against the central catalogue to a single canonical course record to end multi-owner duplication. Severity is high: this is the highest-traffic, highest-stakes top-of-funnel stage and the platform seam plus absent comparison directly impede the conversion the whole estate is built to drive.

How to apply & the application funnel (enquiry → apply → portal) [HIGH]

There is no single "Apply" path: the application action forks silently across three disconnected systems (VTAC, the walled eStudent eApplications portal, and a CRM enquiry form), so the most decisive moment in the funnel is the most fragmented and the least owned by study.unimelb.

What exists. Two parallel "how to apply" footprints on study.unimelb (n=2,005 pages scanned): a CENTRAL hub /how-to-apply/ = 280 pages, segmented by audience (graduate-coursework 75, undergraduate 70, auditions-and-interviews 39, international-exchange/study-abroad 18, equity-entry 15, graduate-research 13, special-entry 12, english-language-requirements 10, fees 6) PLUS a separate per-course "How to apply" tab living inside the catalogue at /find/courses/.../how-to-apply/ (128 instances found in the sample; one per course across ~2,944 catalogue pages). The portal gateway is /how-to-apply/your-online-application (+ /application-help, /instructions-to-upload-documents, /indicative-turn-around-times). change-of-preference = a single page (/change-of-preference/ + /change-of-preference/key-dates). study.unimelb is also the HEAVIEST estate (median 304KB, max 1.1MB/page), so these decision pages are the slowest to load. Evidence: analysis/full-scrape/prospective-sections.csv; crawl/study-unimelb-edu-au/pages/{meta.json,links.json,page.html}.

Journey friction

- The 'apply' action is not singular - it forks by audience into 3 unconnected systems with no unifying 'Apply' button: domestic UG → vtac.edu.au (75 outbound links to VTAC, an EXTERNAL government admissions centre); graduate/international → a walled eStudent portal at prod.ss.unimelb.edu.au/student/SM/eApplications/eAppLogin.aspx and unimelb-web.t1cloud.com (TechnologyOne, uncrawlable); the applicant must self-diagnose which one applies to them.
- Enquiry is conflated with applying: the dominant outbound contextual flow from the apply journey is 1,493 links to forms.your.unimelb.edu.au ('Register for updates'/'Enquire') - a CRM lead-capture form, NOT an application. The two top 'apply'-adjacent CTAs site-wide are 'arrow-righthow to apply' (243) and the CRM 'enquire' form, so the loudest button collects a lead rather than starting an application.
- The real 'Apply now' CTA rarely resolves to an application: across the whole study site, distinct 'Apply now' anchors point mostly to vtac.edu.au (6) or back into study.unimelb itself (4) - plus accommodation/college providers (starrezhousing,

colleges.unimelb) - there is no consistent, course-level deep link into the graduate application portal.

- The portal is a hard, uncrawlable wall: /your-online-application hands off to a login page (eAppLogin.aspx); applicants who hit trouble are bounced to studentit.unimelb.edu.au and students.unimelb.edu.au/stop1 - support for the application sits on the CURRENT-student domain before the person is even a student.
- Deadlines/key dates are scattered per-course ('Key dates' anchors resolve to dozens of individual /find/courses/.../how-to-apply/ pages) rather than a single authoritative applicant deadlines calendar; change-of-preference is a lone page reached mainly from undergraduate-courses, not from the main apply hub.

Fragmentation

- CENTRAL vs CATALOGUE duplication: the /how-to-apply/ hub (280) is paralleled by a per-course 'How to apply' tab inside /find/courses/ (~one per course), so apply guidance exists in two structures that must be kept in sync - the same content split between a journey hub and a catalogue tab.
- CENTRAL vs FACULTY duplication: 817 faculty-hosted /study/ prospective pages run their own recruitment funnels (biomedsciences 189, education 133, finearts-music 122, law 61) and link back to study.unimelb 'how to apply' independently - some courses (e.g. finearts-music auditions) route applicants off to faculty sites (161 outbound links to finearts-music).
- Enquiry-form fragmentation: the single 'Register for updates' concept is implemented as 9 distinct forms.your.unimelb form IDs (/4746909 x1,223, /4746916 x1,089, /4746923, /4746915, /4747167, /4747068 ...), each tagged with a per-course CRM code (?cc=B-BMED, ?cc=GC-PROP) - one logical action, nine endpoints.
- Eligibility/fees logic is split off into its own micro-sections (english-language-requirements 10, fees 6, equity-entry 15, special-entry 12, advanced-standing 3) that the applicant must reassemble themselves; the prerequisite/eligibility truth also depends on handbook.unimelb (4,391 outbound links from study.unimelb), a third platform.

The seam. The decisive seam is enquiry -> apply -> portal, and it breaks three ways into uncrawled systems: (1) CRM capture at forms.your.unimelb (1,493 links, 9 form IDs) intercepts intent before application; (2) the actual application exits to either vtac.edu.au (external gov system, domestic UG) OR the walled eStudent eApplications portal at prod.ss.unimelb.edu.au / unimelb-web.t1cloud.com behind eAppLogin.aspx (grad/intl) - neither crawlable, inferred from outbound links. The downstream apply->enrol seam is then THIN and vocabulary-less: only 373 contextual links study.unimelb -> students.unimelb, and from apply pages the handoff anchor is a generic 'students' (247 times) with only a handful of 'defer your offer'(4)/'decline your offer'(4)/'get started at melbourne'(6) - the offer->accept->enrol moment crosses a domain boundary (study.unimelb -> students.unimelb/{faculty}) with no shared URL, taxonomy, or signal that it is the same university (corroborated by analysis/lifecycle-cross-corpus.md).

Recommendation. Treat 'Apply' as one product, not a content topic. (1) Build a single applicant decision gateway that asks the 2-3 disambiguating questions (domestic/international, UG/grad-coursework/research, course) and routes deterministically to the ONE correct destination (VTAC vs eStudent eApplications), instead of forcing the applicant to read 280 segmented pages to self-select. (2) Visually and semantically separate 'Enquire/Register for updates' (CRM lead) from 'Apply' (start application) so the loud CRM button stops standing in for the application action; consolidate the 9 forms.your form IDs behind one tracked entry. (3) Bridge the portal wall: give /your-online-application a clear, course-aware deep link and a status/turnaround expectation, and stop routing pre-applicants to current-student support (stop1/studentit) without context. (4) Author the offer->accept->enrol handoff as a shared, named journey across the study.unimelb -> students.unimelb boundary (replace 247 generic 'students' anchors with explicit 'accept your offer / enrol' steps) - the same fragmentation fix the current-student estate needs, one stage earlier. (5) Collapse the central /how-to-apply/ hub and the per-course catalogue 'How to apply' tab into one source of truth, and pull deadlines into a single applicant key-dates calendar rather than per-course pages.

Entry requirements, eligibility & pathways (prospective/applicant) [HIGH]

A prospective student can usually find that an entry scheme exists, but almost never gets a self-serviceable yes/no — authoritative requirements live on the handbook, the eligibility tools are explicitly "guide only," and every real decision is punted to VTAC or the uncrawlable application portal.

What exists. On study.unimelb the eligibility/pathways content is split into small separate trees: /how-to-apply/equity-entry-schemes (13 crawled pages incl. Access Melbourne UG/grad, Narrm, Elite Athletes), /how-to-apply/special-entry-access-schemes

(8 pages — STAT/SAT/non-school-leaver), /how-to-apply/english-language-requirements (8: hub + UG + grad + a 2025 variant + trailing-slash dupes), /how-to-apply/single-subject-study (6), /how-to-apply/advanced-standing (3: hub + apply + credit-calculator), /how-to-apply/transferring-courses (1, UG-only), plus /study-with-us/guaranteed-undergraduate-to-graduate-study-pathways (10, incl. 8 Graduate Degree Packages) and /find/pathways (28 career-route pages e.g. /lawyer, /doctor, /engineer). Self-service tools exist — the Access Melbourne eligibility calculator (hash 5be72d83bf30a46d) and the credit calculator (6a62f86e3c510078) — but both state "This calculator is a guide only." Authoritative per-course entry requirements (ATAR, prerequisites, selection rank, English) do NOT live here: a sampled catalogue page (find/courses/graduate/graduate-certificate-in-digital-engineering-infrastructure, hash 0010097d85def18a) surfaces an "Entry requirements" section that links out to handbook.unimelb.edu.au (2 handbook links on that single page). Pages are heavy (227–357KB typical for this stage).

Journey friction

- No single answer to 'can I get in?': the english-language hub (ffb55c1f9159baed) explicitly says 'Every course has specific requirements which you can find on the course page,' and ATAR/prerequisites sit on the handbook — so a student must traverse study.unimelb -> course page -> handbook.unimelb to assemble eligibility for ONE course. Eligibility is decomposed across at least 4 platforms and is never assembled in one place for the student.
- Self-service tools stop short of an answer: both the Access Melbourne calculator and the credit calculator are labelled 'a guide only' and explicitly defer the real decision — 'submit an equity schemes and scholarships application ... in VTAC' / 'submit a course application and ... your subjects will be officially assessed.' The Access Melbourne calculator also only lists ~10 broad bachelors (Arts, Commerce, Science, Biomedicine, Design, Music, etc.), not the full UG catalogue, and assumes prerequisites are already met — so a prospective student in a course outside that shortlist gets no estimate at all.
- Eligibility self-assessment dead-ends at uncrawable systems: domestic UG eligibility is decided in VTAC (off-site), graduate/international eligibility in the University's online application portal (behind a wall), and credit is only 'officially assessed' after a course application is lodged. The public estate can describe schemes but cannot confirm eligibility — the answer always requires submitting an application or contacting someone.
- Wrong-content / mislabeled URL in the non-school-leaver pathway: the special-entry URL .../access-melbourne-undergraduate/eligibility/non-school-leaver/special-tertiary-admissions-test-stat (hash ecef4825e4b14dae) renders a page titled 'Mature age entry pathways' — a STAT-specific path serving generic mature-age content, so a student looking specifically for the STAT route lands on the wrong (more generic) page.
- Trailing-slash duplicate pages exist within the stage (e.g. english-language-requirements with and without trailing slash; undergraduate-/graduate-english-language-requirements each duplicated; find/pathways/doctor, /nurse, /physiotherapist, /psychologist, /veterinarian, /speech-pathologist all crawled twice), inflating the surface a student must disambiguate.
- Transferring/RPL coverage is thin and lopsided: /how-to-apply/transferring-courses is a single UG-only page that redirects graduate transfers to the current-student site ('see current student transfers'), and advanced-standing/RPL is only 3 pages — a prospective student wanting to know what prior learning counts gets very little before having to apply.

Fragmentation

- Central duplication: the entire 'Access Melbourne undergraduate' sub-tree is mounted under TWO parents — /how-to-apply/equity-entry-schemes/... AND /how-to-apply/special-entry-access-schemes/... — with 3 overlapping slugs (access-melbourne-graduate, access-melbourne-undergraduate, access-melbourne-undergraduate/access-melbourne-eligibility) and inconsistent nesting depth (the eligibility-calculator sits at .../eligibility-calculator under one parent but .../access-melbourne-eligibility/eligibility-calculator under the other). Same scheme, two information architectures.
- Central vs handbook: the definitive entry requirements (ATAR, prerequisites, selection rank, English level per course) are owned by handbook.unimelb.edu.au, not by this stage — study.unimelb -> handbook is the single biggest contextual flow on the estate at 4,391 links. study.unimelb pages describe the schemes/process; the handbook holds the numbers. The two are different platforms with different IA, and the prospective student must reconcile them.
- Central vs faculty: faculties host parallel prospective entry/apply content — law.unimelb (~63 pages mentioning entry/apply/eligibility), education.unimelb (~49), science.unimelb (~6) — duplicating or partially restating the central funnel (817 faculty /study/ pages estate-wide), so requirements for the same course can be stated in two voices.
- English-language requirements are themselves split (a general hub + separate UG and graduate pages + a '2025-english-language-requirements' variant), and the per-course English level still lives on the course/handbook page — so English eligibility is fragmented across the hub, the audience-specific page, and the catalogue.

The seam. The defining seam is the handoff out of public, browsable content into systems that hold the actual decision: study.unimelb (scheme/process descriptions + "guide only" calculators) -> handbook.unimelb (authoritative per-course ATAR/prerequisites/English, 4,391 links) for the requirement, and then -> VTAC (domestic UG, off-site) or the University's online application portal / my.unimelb (graduate & international, uncrawable, inferred from outbound links) for the binding eligibility/credit assessment. Every self-service path in this stage terminates at "submit an application in VTAC" or "submit a course application and it will be officially assessed" — the public estate can inform but cannot confirm; confirmation only exists across that wall.

Recommendation. Make eligibility answerable in one place, per course, before the wall. (1) Pull the authoritative entry requirements (ATAR/selection rank, prerequisites, English level) from the handbook onto the course page itself so "can I get in?" is answered without a handbook hop — the catalogue page already reserves an "Entry requirements" slot but currently just links out. (2) Collapse the duplicated Access Melbourne tree to a single canonical location and redirect the other parent (equity-entry vs special-entry should not each own a full copy), and fix the STAT URL (ecef4825e4b14dae) that serves mature-age content. (3) Expand the Access Melbourne calculator beyond ~10 bachelors to the full UG catalogue (or clearly scope it), and reframe both calculators from "guide only / then apply" toward a clearer eligibility-checker that states exactly what's indicative vs binding and what evidence VTAC/the portal will need. (4) De-duplicate trailing-slash pages and consolidate the three-way English-language split. (5) Add a single "routes in" overview that unifies the currently scattered schemes (equity, special/non-school-leaver, mature-age, guaranteed UG->grad, advanced-standing/RPL, single-subject, transfer) so a prospective student can self-identify their pathway in one view instead of discovering each tree separately.

Fees, cost & scholarships for applicants ("can I afford it") [HIGH]

Tuition numbers are genuinely present and per-course (not bounced to the handbook), but the wider affordability story — loans, cost-of-living, scholarships — is shattered across audience-split pages, one orphan cost page, and a separate scholarships platform, with no unified "what will this cost me" hub.

What exists. Tuition lives in two parallel structures on study.unimelb (2,005 distinct URLs crawled): (1) a journey hub of 5 pages under /how-to-apply/fees (master "Tuition fees and other study fees" 228KB, student-contribution-amounts/CSP, SSAF, application-fee, previous-years) PLUS 9 audience-split "fees-and-payments" pages (UG / grad-coursework / grad-research / single-subject x domestic/international); and (2) ~125 crawled per-course /find/courses/.../fees/ templates — one tab of 7 per course across 440 crawled course landings, implying the cited ~363 across the full 2,944-page catalogue. Per-course fee pages carry REAL dollar figures (e.g. Master of Criminology \$32,000 CSP / \$48,992 full-fee; Master of Art Curatorship \$102,884) and FEE-HELP/HECS/Commonwealth-supported body copy — handbook bounce on fee pages = 0. Cost-of-living = a SINGLE page (/student-life/cost-of-living, 229KB). Accommodation = 34 pages (/accommodation: eligibility, how-to-apply, International House + its own scholarships, Lisa Bellair House). Scholarship DISCOVERY is not on study.unimelb at all — it is a separate site, scholarships.unimelb, reached via 411 contextual links from study (1,865 estate-wide). Paths: /Users/djmulholland/Documents/Claude/projects/unimelb-current-students-ia/crawl/study-unimelb-edu-au/pages/e1628dd6712449b7/ (master fees hub), analysis/full-scrape/cross-site-flow.csv, analysis/full-scrape/prospective-sections.csv.

Journey friction

- No unified 'affordability / paying for your degree' hub exists — grep for afford|funding|paying-for|finance-your across all 2,005 study URLs returns zero. Cost is assembled from 3+ disconnected places: per-course fee tab, separate cost-of-living page, separate accommodation section, separate scholarships site.
- Loan-scheme guidance is ASYMMETRIC by audience: domestic UG and grad-coursework fees-and-payments pages carry the full FEE-HELP / HECS-HELP / SA-HELP / OS-HELP / census-date suite, but EVERY international fee page (UG, grad-coursework, grad-research, study-abroad) returns NONE — international applicants see a bare large number (48k–103k) with no payment-plan, deposit, or affordability framing on the page.
- The master /how-to-apply/fees hub's own outbound anchors mention only 'Student contribution amounts (CSP)' and 'Previous years' fees' — no anchor surfaces FEE-HELP, HECS-HELP, deferral or any loan scheme; a prospective student must already know to click into the right audience sub-page to find them.
- Cost-of-living is one page that offloads the actual cost answer to 4 EXTERNAL sites (costofliving.studyaustralia.gov.au, studyaustralia.gov.au, studymelbourne.vic.gov.au, insiderguides.com.au, dffh.vic.gov.au) rather than giving an integrated

Melbourne weekly-budget figure tied to fees.

- Scholarship discovery is a generic dead-end handoff: the dominant anchor into scholarships.unimelb is 'Search for scholarships' (111×) / 'Find a scholarship that's right...' (28×) — a search box on another platform, not a result pre-filtered to the course the applicant is viewing. Scholarships.unimelb then fans onward AGAIN to go.unimelb (44), futurestudents.unimelb (38) and gradresearch (17), deepening the maze.
- Total cost picture forces the applicant across ≥4 domains — study.unimelb (fees/cost/accommodation) → scholarships.unimelb (funding) → forms.your.unimelb (the only CTA on per-course fee pages is 'Register', 2 links each, not 'estimate my cost') → and the real application/payment happens behind a wall (my.unimelb / portal, uncrawable).

Fragmentation

- Scholarships are re-linked INDEPENDENTLY by every faculty rather than through one costed funnel: study 411, medicine 325, finearts-music 221, education 150, eng 129, science 127, law 109, mdhs 92, fbe 88, arts 85 — 1,865 links total into one scholarships.unimelb site, each faculty maintaining its own entry points.
- Per-course fee pages each independently re-handoff (forms.your ×2 + scholarships ×1 per page) instead of routing to a single funding/affordability hub — the same CRM-register + scholarship-search pattern duplicated ~363 times.
- Tuition is split across central journey pages (/how-to-apply/fees) AND embedded per-course tabs (/find/courses/.../fees) — two systems of record for 'what does it cost', with the journey hub giving scheme rules and the course tab giving the number, and no single page holding both for a given course.
- Cost lives on study.unimelb but funding (scholarships.unimelb), the persuasion/cost-of-living-adjacent content (study /student-life), accommodation cost (/accommodation), and the actual fee payment (portal/my.unimelb) are four different surfaces — the 'can I afford it' answer is owned by nobody.
- Handbook is correctly NOT the fee source (0 handbook links from fee pages), but this means the course-detail platform a researcher uses (handbook, 4,391 links) and the cost platform (study fee tab) are different sites — a student comparing courses in the handbook must jump back to study to see price.

The seam. The make-or-break seam is the per-course fee page → funding/decision handoff. A per-course /fees/ page shows the real number and FEE-HELP eligibility, but its only forward CTAs are 'Register for updates' (forms.your.unimelb ×2) and a generic 'Search for scholarships' bounce to scholarships.unimelb — never a course-contextual 'estimate your total cost' or pre-filtered scholarship list. From scholarships.unimelb the trail fans onward to go.unimelb / futurestudents / gradresearch, and the actual fee payment/deposit happens behind the application portal wall (my.unimelb, uncrawled, inferred from outbound links). So the applicant crosses from a costed course page into (a) a CRM capture form, (b) a separate scholarship search silo, and (c) an authenticated portal — three different systems, none of which carries the course context forward.

Recommendation. Create a single course-contextual "What will this cost me" panel and stop scattering the answer. (1) On each per-course /fees/ page, render an integrated cost block: tuition (already present) + indicative cost-of-living + accommodation range + a pre-filtered list of scholarships relevant to THAT course/level/citizenship — pulled from scholarships.unimelb via API rather than a generic 'Search for scholarships' bounce (kill the 111× generic anchor). (2) Fix the international asymmetry: every international fee page must carry deposit, payment-plan and 'no FEE-HELP — here's what that means' framing, not NONE — international applicants pay the highest numbers and currently get the least guidance. (3) Build one estate-level 'Fees, funding & scholarships' hub under /how-to-apply that unifies the 5 journey fee pages + the 9 audience-split fees-and-payments pages + cost-of-living + accommodation cost + scholarship discovery, so the 14+ fragments and the separate scholarships site resolve to a single affordability narrative. (4) Make cost-of-living a real integrated Melbourne weekly-budget tool tied to fees, not a 1-page bounce to 4 government/third-party sites. (5) Replace the 'Register' CTA on fee pages with an 'Estimate your total annual cost' interaction that carries course context into the funnel.

International applicant journey (discover → research → eligibility/English → apply → offer → accept + tuition deposit → conditional/full CoE → student visa → enrol)

[HIGH]

The international journey is the estate's highest-complexity path and its most tangled: triple-authored once per audience track, hard-dependent on three external compliance systems the site does not own, and — critically — it pushes pre-

enrolment applicants into the logged-out current-student hub for the visa-gating OSHC/CoE/acceptance steps, with a different destination URL each time.

What exists. On study.unimelb the dedicated international footprint is thin relative to its complexity. The only large cluster is /how-to-apply/international-exchange-and-study-abroad-applications = 18 pages (inbound exchange/study-abroad, a separate sub-journey: applications, entry-requirements, program-options/{study-areas,selecting-subjects,research-program}, tuition-fees, important-dates, getting-ready/accommodation-options, our-support-services, offers-and-enrolments). /english-language-requirements = 10. The degree-seeking international path is a per-audience international-applications sub-tree replicated THREE times: undergraduate-study/international-applications (~13 pages incl. applications, entry-requirements, fees-and-payments, offers-and-enrolments, under-18-international-students, plus a deep recognised-international-qualifications tree — Australia-Yr12, GCE-A-levels, IB diploma, NZ-NCEA, australian-foundation-programs); graduate-coursework-study/international-applications (4: applications/entry-requirements/fees-and-payments/offers-and-enrolments); graduate-research/international-applications (3). The compliance spine is a set of singletons: conditional-confirmation-of-enrolment (1 page, hash c2633aa692ce1721), authorised-education-agent (1, 36ece15a07d80710), domestic-and-international-student-definitions (1, b0d344d257df33b8), guaranteed-and-minimum-entry-scores-for-international-students (1). study.unimelb is the heaviest estate (median 304KB, max 1.1MB page-weight) — these data-dense international pages are the slowest to load for the audience most likely on offshore/mobile connections.

Journey friction

- The visa-critical step (OSHC) lives on the WRONG side of the enrolment wall. On UG-intl offers-and-enrolments (494999801eae8f4e) 'Overseas Student Health Cover' links to students.unimelb.edu.au/admin/student-visas/overseas-student-health-cover-oshc — the logged-out CURRENT-student hub — even though the applicant has not enrolled and may not yet hold a visa. The same is true for the Student Acceptance and Payment Agreement and 'Get started at Melbourne'. Pre-enrolment students are dumped into a site addressed to people who already are students.
- The same OSHC step resolves to THREE different destinations depending on which audience track you entered: UG offers -> /admin/student-visas/...oshc; GradCW offers (9f0963ed3398b14a) -> /support-and-wellbeing/international-student-support/visas/healthcare-for-other-visa-types AND /support-and-wellbeing/international-student-support/visas/. An applicant comparing a dual-degree or switching level gets inconsistent, contradictory instructions for the one step that gates their visa.
- The CoE -> visa chain is a hard dependency on systems the site cannot see into. The conditional-CoE page explains a CoE is only issued AFTER you accept and pay the tuition deposit, and 'You will need your CoE to lodge a student visa application' — but acceptance+deposit happens in an uncrawlable portal (a distinct intlstudaccept.unimelb.edu.au 'International Student Acceptance and Payment' system surfaced in anchor-text), and the visa step hands off to immi.homeaffairs.gov.au (visa-finder/study, visa-listing). The applicant must shuttle study.unimelb -> portal -> Home Affairs -> back, with the site narrating a process it doesn't host.
- Domestic vs international forks the ENTIRE journey at the very first decision and the fork is under-signposted. The definitions page (b0d344d257df33b8) states student type is set by citizenship/visa at time of application (not residence) and changes how you apply (VTAC vs direct), the fees, eligibility for government assistance, and visa/enrolment requirements — yet it is a single buried page, and the two paths thereafter run as fully parallel, separately-authored trees rather than one path with an international overlay.
- The 18-page inbound exchange/study-abroad cluster is a near-separate product co-mingled under the same /how-to-apply/ roof: it has its own tuition-fees, important-dates, entry-requirements and offers-and-enrolments that DUPLICATE the degree-seeking ones, and it leaks to yet another platform (mobility.unimelb.edu.au / www.mobility.unimelb.edu.au 'Inbound Exchange and Study Abroad' website). A non-award exchange applicant and a degree applicant cannot tell which 'international how-to-apply' is theirs.
- English-language-requirements shows live staleness/duplication: a '2025 English language requirements' page (46a726c7472d9294) is still published as of 2026-06-27, and the SAME page is crawled twice because a /_nocache variant (9a1a7d083137eddb) is exposed as a distinct URL — plus separate undergraduate- and graduate-english-language-requirements pages restate overlapping rules.
- The authorised-education-agent page (the channel a large share of international applicants actually use) is a SINGLE page and routes complaints/escalation back into the current-student hub (students.unimelb.edu.au Stop 1, student-complaints-and-

grievances) and to the ESOS Act on education.gov.au — again sending a not-yet-student into current-student and government systems for recourse.

Fragmentation

- CENTRAL triple-authoring: the international degree path is written three times (undergraduate-study/, graduate-coursework-study/, graduate-research/ each carry their own international-applications/{applications,entry-requirements,fees-and-payments,offers-and-enrolments}). The compliance content (CoE, definitions, agents, English) is then authored a fourth way as shared singletons hanging off /how-to-apply/ root — so an applicant assembles their journey from two incompatible structures (audience-segmented vs topic-singleton).
- CENTRAL vs CURRENT-HUB split mid-compliance: the visa/OSHC/acceptance/CoE-consequence content is split across study.unimelb (the marketing/recruitment estate) and students.unimelb (the operational estate) with the boundary falling in the MIDDLE of the single most consequential, compliance-bound moment. study.unimelb->students.unimelb is only 373 contextual links total across the whole 4,048-page estate, and a disproportionate share of the international ones are these pre-enrolment OSHC/CoE/acceptance jumps.
- PORTAL fragmentation: at least three separate transactional systems sit behind the content — the main application portal (your-online-application, behind a wall), intlstudaccept.unimelb.edu.au (International Student Acceptance & Payment), and mobility.unimelb.edu.au (inbound exchange) — none crawlable, each a context switch with its own login and vocabulary.
- FACULTY parallel: faculty estates host their own international applicant content under their /study/ trees (817 faculty /study/ pages overall), and at least one is already broken — mdhs.unimelb.edu.au/research/research-training/current-students/international-students/overseas-student-health-cover and .../renewing-your-student-visa both 404 (dead-pages.csv). So international OSHC/visa guidance is authored centrally AND per-faculty, and the faculty copies are already rotting.
- HANDBOOK dependency unchanged for this audience: course/entry detail still lives on handbook.unimelb (study.unimelb->handbook = 4,391 links), so an international applicant checking a specific program's entry/English score crosses into a fourth platform with no international framing at all.

The seam. The accept->CoE->visa->enrol compliance seam — the point where a paid, accepted international applicant must obtain a CoE (issued only after acceptance + tuition-deposit in the intlstudaccept/your-online-application portal), use it to lodge a student visa at immi.homeaffairs.gov.au, arrange OSHC, and only then enrol. This seam is split mid-stream across study.unimelb (narrates it), students.unimelb (hosts OSHC/acceptance/CoE-consequence pages, logged-out, with three inconsistent OSHC URLs), and two-to-three uncrawlable transactional portals plus an external government site. It is the estate's only journey where the content owner does not own the controlling system, and the apply->enrol handoff (already thin at 373 links estate-wide) is at its most fragile precisely where compliance is mandatory and irreversible.

Recommendation. Build a single international-applicant spine that overlays the existing audience tracks instead of re-authoring them: one canonical, level-aware sequence Eligibility & English → Apply → Offer → Accept & pay deposit → CoE (conditional/full) → Student visa → OSHC → Enrol, with UG/GradCW/GradResearch as a toggle, not three forks. (1) Resolve the OSHC/CoE/acceptance content to ONE canonical URL each and link to it identically from every track — kill the current 3-way OSHC inconsistency. (2) Bring the pre-enrolment compliance steps that today live on the logged-out students.unimelb hub onto the prospective estate (or build an authenticated 'accepted applicant' space) so a not-yet-enrolled student is never dropped into a current-student site for visa-gating tasks. (3) Make the portal seams explicit: clearly label each hop into the application portal, intlstudaccept, mobility, and Home Affairs as 'you are leaving to do X, return here for Y', since the site narrates a process it doesn't host. (4) Hygiene: retire/redirect the stale '2025 English language requirements' page and suppress the /_nocache duplicate; fix or redirect the MDHS 404 OSHC/visa faculty pages; and collapse faculty-hosted international OSHC/visa guidance into the central spine to stop the parallel copies rotting. (5) Surface the domestic/international definitions fork as a first-step gate on the how-to-apply entry, not a buried page, so applicants self-route correctly before the VTAC-vs-direct and fee divergence bites.

apply→offer→enrol handoff (prospective study.unimelb → current students.unimelb) [HIGH]

The crossover from accepted-applicant to enrolled student is a single cold cross-domain link ("Get Started at Melbourne") for most students — only domestic VTAC undergraduates get a genuine guided "you got in, here's what's next" bridge; everyone else falls off the prospective site into a different domain with no continuity.

What exists. Just ~16 dedicated handoff-stage pages on study.unimelb, split two ways. (a) /how-to-apply: five "offers-and-enrolments" pages — one per audience (UG domestic f88e419ebd6070f3, UG intl 494999801eae8f4e, grad-cw domestic fa08f2f8dd51c651, grad-cw intl 9f0963ed3398b14a, exchange/study-abroad d305fc01b339b4bc) — plus conditional-CoE (c2633aa692ce1721, the only CoE page, 35 links/9 internal) and your-online-application (2 pp). (b) An 8-page change-of-preference cluster under /study-with-us/undergraduate-courses/ (740428db..; incl. your-guide-to-starting-uni a37d86b6.., faqs, atar-guarantees, key-dates, interstate) — the only warm "starting uni" content, and it is UG-VTAC-only. /change-of-preference top-level = 1 page (prospective-sections.csv). Every offers page routes to one destination: students.unimelb.edu.au/new-students/get-started. The handoff headline of 373 study→students contextual links is misleading: across 2,005 crawled study pages, 99.9% link to students.unimelb but almost entirely via the generic "Students" mega-nav chrome (2,001 of 2,386 raw link instances ≈ 84%). Purposeful handoff links are tiny: only 22 pages link to any /new-students path and only ~10–13 to /new-students/get-started. The single biggest "real" study→students target is WAM (80, a current-student results page reached from the catalogue — not a handoff at all).

Journey friction

- Warm onboarding is undergraduate-only: your-guide-to-starting-uni (a37d86b6) deep-links accepted UG students to the new-student-checklist, Melbourne Orientation, My Course Planner, Academic Skills, peer mentoring and wellbeing — a real guided path. Confirmed BOTH graduate-coursework offers pages (domestic + international) link to NEITHER the starting-uni guide NOR the new-student-checklist; they get only the bare 'Get Started at Melbourne' link. Graduate and international cohorts cross over cold.
- The crossover is one undifferentiated link for most students: 'Get started at Melbourne' → students.unimelb.edu.au/new-students/get-started. Nothing in the URL, branding or breadcrumb signals it is the same university or the next step — the accepted student leaves study.unimelb and lands in a separate domain (students.unimelb is a distinct corpus, not even crawled here), exactly the 'four websites pretending to be one university' seam in lifecycle-cross-corpus.md §4.
- The change-of-preference 'bridge' is mis-shelved and time-bound: it sits under /study-with-us/undergraduate-courses/ (a persuasion/discovery path), not under /how-to-apply/, and is overtly seasonal ('Make Melbourne yours in 2026'; FAQs say 'Details for Semester 1 2027 entry will be updated soon') — so the one warm onboarding asset is hard to find from the application journey and goes stale between intake cycles.
- Defer/decline and key-admin links are inconsistent across audiences, so the same action has different URLs depending on entry path: UG uses students.unimelb/new-students/defer-or-decline-your-offer/defer-my-offer and .../subject-enrolment/census-dates, while graduate-coursework uses students.unimelb/new-students/defer-my-offer and /course-admin/key-dates. The handoff is hand-stitched per page, not a shared component.
- International enrolment — the most complex path (accept → Student Acceptance and Payment Agreement → CoE → OSHC → visa) — is the most thinly supported on the prospective side: the conditional-CoE page is the ONLY CoE page (and contextually links onward to students.unimelb only via the generic mega-nav), and the substantive steps live behind links into students.unimelb/get-started/coursework-international/agreement and forms.your.unimelb — i.e. the prospective site explains the concept but offloads every action across the domain wall.
- The actual application + offer acceptance happen entirely off-estate (VTAC at vtac.edu.au/offers for UG; an application/admissions portal behind a login for graduate/international). study.unimelb narrates 'follow the instructions in your offer email' but the accept action itself is never on a crawlable page — the offer→accept moment is invisible to the public estate.

Fragmentation

- Two owners author the handoff in two places with no shared model: the application-journey team owns the five /how-to-apply offers-and-enrolments pages (functional, audience-segmented, cold), while a recruitment/UG team owns the 8-page change-of-preference 'starting uni' cluster (warm, seasonal, UG-only) — the warm content and the functional content never converge into one 'after you're accepted' destination.
- The destination side (students.unimelb/new-students/get-started, /new-student-checklist, orientation) is a THIRD owner on a separate domain; study.unimelb can only point at it, and points inconsistently (UG vs grad URL variants), so the prospective estate has no authoritative, shared link set into onboarding.
- Faculties add a fourth layer: 817 faculty /study/ prospective pages parallel the central funnel (biomedical 189, education 133, finearts-music 122, law 61), and 49 faculty study-pages link back into study.unimelb — but they offer their own offer/accept

guidance with no guaranteed convergence on the central get-started path, so an accepted student's 'what's next' differs by which faculty page they entered from.

- CoE/enrolment terminology is split across systems with no shared addressing: 'Confirmation of Enrolment' is explained on [study.unimelb](#) (conditional-CoE) but issued/actioned on [students.unimelb](#) and [forms.your.unimelb](#); VTAC owns UG offers; the application portal owns grad/international acceptance — four vocabularies for one accept→enrol moment (lifecycle-cross-corpus.md §5).

The seam. The load-bearing seam is the single link "Get Started at Melbourne" → [students.unimelb.edu.au/new-students/get-started](#), the lone purposeful crossover from prospective to current — present on only ~10–13 of 2,005 study pages and crossing into an entirely separate (here-uncrawled) domain. Secondary seams cross into systems off the public estate: VTAC ([vtac.edu.au/offers](#)) for UG offer/accept, an application/admissions portal behind a login for graduate/international acceptance, [forms.your.unimelb](#) (the Student Acceptance and Payment Agreement / CoE actions), and [my.unimelb](#) for the new student account — all inferred from outbound links, none crawlable. The headline "373 study→students contextual links" overstates the bridge: ~84% is generic mega-nav chrome, so the true handoff surface is a handful of hand-placed links, not a designed transition.

Recommendation. Build one audience-aware "You're in — what happens next" destination that owns the accept→enrol transition for ALL cohorts, not just domestic VTAC UG. Concretely: (1) Promote a single canonical post-offer hub under /how-to-apply/ (e.g. /how-to-apply/after-you-apply) that consolidates the five scattered offers-and-enrolments pages and surfaces the warm starting-uni content (checklist, orientation, course planner, peer mentoring) to graduate-coursework and international applicants too — today confirmed missing for both graduate offers pages. (2) Make the crossover legible: replace the bare "Get Started at Melbourne" link with a branded, signposted transition that tells the student they are moving from [study.unimelb](#) to [students.unimelb](#) and why, and standardise the defer/decline + census/key-dates targets into one shared link component (kill the UG-vs-grad URL drift). (3) De-seasonalise and re-shelve the change-of-preference 'your-guide-to-starting-uni' asset so it lives on the application journey year-round rather than under undergraduate-courses marketing with a 2026 expiry. (4) Strengthen the thinnest, highest-stakes path: give international applicants a continuous accept→CoE→OSHC→visa→enrol spine on the prospective side that hands off cleanly to [students.unimelb/get-started/coursework-international](#), since the prospective estate currently explains CoE on exactly one page and offloads every action across the domain wall. The strategic prize (lifecycle-cross-corpus.md §What-this-adds #1): scope the IA fix to the apply→enrol seam, not current-students only — this is the same fragmentation one stage earlier, and a current-students-only remediation leaves the moment a student converts from prospect to enrolled untouched.

Decision & persuasion ("why Melbourne") — the conversion/decision layer of the prospective journey (study-with-us, student-life, discover, openday, accommodation, rankings/outcomes/employability) [MEDIUM]

The persuasion layer is content-rich and genuinely wired to the practical funnel (apply/fees/eligibility links sit inside the body, not just chrome) — but it converts almost entirely into a CRM "Register for updates" capture rather than the catalogue, its most decision-critical surface (Open Day) dead-ends without routing to courses, and every page is a 230-290KB payload that is ~40% un-cached inline SVG, punishing prospective students on mobile/limited data.

What exists. [study.unimelb](#) persuasion sections by link-graph (prospective-sections.csv): /study-with-us 148, /student-life 126, /accommodation 46, /discover 24, /openday 5. Crawl captured 193 live pages in this stage: study-with-us 122 (graduate-courses 64, professional-development 20, undergraduate-courses 12, UG→PG pathways 10, online-courses 7), student-life 33 (meet-our-students 19 student profiles, inside-melbourne 4, life-at-melbourne 2), accommodation 31 (per-college pages: wilam-hall 5, international-house 5, little-hall, the-lofts, medley-hall...), openday 4, discover 3. Persuasion is real and substantial: 62 of these pages cite rankings/QS/THE/"world-leading"/top-N in MAIN content (284 mentions); employability/career language is dense (our-degrees page = 31 career mentions). Hub pages: /study-with-us/our-degrees [356869f98f9c09a6], /study-with-us/the-melbourne-curriculum [1f743e555bf7f136], /student-life/inside-melbourne [4075e67eabfa406a], /student-life/meet-our-students [42f9d17eb2c14bb5]. [study.unimelb](#) is the heaviest estate in the audit (page-weight.csv: median 304KB, p90 416KB, max 1.13MB across 2,005 weighed pages); every persuasion hub measured 232-282KB. Zero orphans on [study.unimelb](#) (orphans.csv) — the stage is well-linked internally.

Journey friction

- PERFORMANCE TAX ON DECISION CONTENT: the our-degrees hub is 289KB of which 112KB (39%) is 61 inline SVGs and 35KB (12%) is inline CSS, plus 28 external